

Food stored in the refrigerator

Fact

Ice and snow was used to preserve food in ancient times, now 85 per cent of all foods are refrigerated.

Table 1 Comparison Data of Shelf Life of Frozen and Refrigerated Foods

Vegetables/ Meat/Dairy/ Fruits	Refrigeration	Freezing
Pears	5 Days	One year
Butter	1–2 months	9 months
Milk	8–20 days	3 months
Lean fish	1–2 days	6–10 months
Fatty fish	1–2 days	2–3 months
Poultry	1–2 days	6–9 months
Bread	1–2 weeks	2–3 months
Flour	1 year	1–2 years
Corn	1–2 days	8 months
Green peas	1–2 days	8 months
Spinach	5–7 days	8 months

Source: foodclubkitchen.com

4.2.1.2 Freezing

Freezing is a means of preserving food through *the application and maintenance of extreme cold temperature (–4°C to –40°C).* It is *effective* because most of the water of the food tissue is changed from *the liquid to the solid state*. This change in the physical state of water retards enzymatic action and stops microbial growth, the cause of food spoilage, thus preserving food. Many foods can be *frozen for twelve months or more* without major changes in size, shape, texture, colour and flavour.

- **Slow freezing process**

It is also known as *sharp freezing*. In this method, the food is frozen under temperatures ranging from *–4°C to –29°C.*



Frozen grapes



Normal grapes

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